Boundaries — Part 3 answer key

#	ID	Answer	Difficulty
3.1	a760f97a-cad4-405b-85a2-3ddd2319a971	D	Hard
3.2	73fd4674-246a-448a-a4b6-263c6268c33a	C	Hard
3.3	6e22e8b6-807a-46a1-9fec-d9dc4525dd5a	B	Hard
3.4	749a7ffa-6183-458d-8c83-89e35fa7ac25	C	Hard
3.5	a5e68a12-2354-4595-9f2a-47885f367e02	C	Hard
3.6	5298757d-b328-4c83-880d-c22c895cef4a	A	Hard
3.7	7f6ba76f-bb2a-48dd-b99b-34aa8174eaa1	D	Hard
3.8	a168e337-aa68-4991-b999-b10743da59e1	C	Hard
3.9	244cf997-b270-4a5d-8ae4-1182edf85856	C	Hard
3.10	01e4ee04-31c9-44d9-be3a-ab16ed00a0c1	D	Hard
3.11	ad3374eb-4b0f-48b6-993c-634ad88d9e0b	C	Hard
3.12	7874904b-6d17-4f70-b5bc-30a06997bf8e	D	Hard
3.13	8ac6a415-aa5d-4d08-bb25-372696f6ec4e	D	Hard
3.14	24931307-5434-4663-9019-dffec331df9a	B	Hard
3.15	d4b00003-4eaa-4d82-94d2-8be9b0ad4e83	A	Hard
3.16	8d60a30c-fcdb-46e7-b6e5-c48625b28d83	B	Hard
3.17	e402c9de-ec5c-4fe3-ae02-d6233c202224	B	Hard
3.18	c9621282-e14b-469a-a221-70a4156b72f3	A	Hard
3.19	2e95b660-ad51-4543-8a1d-23e3151b4d55	A	Hard
3.20	d608f1d2-cacf-4645-8c8c-d4f77b5cbdeb	B	Hard
3.21	e7084bbb-2fb4-4871-be43-276160350da2	C	Hard
3.22	215c6881-8e10-41de-acfd-9776297d808a	B	Hard

3.23	5c126f26-375f-4a6c-8e1b-51954164e3ac	C	Hard
3.24	86cf8f91-b7a8-4855-8d80-1cbaa66e7529	C	Hard
3.25	86d7d04f-3f8f-48a2-8086-f4465af48abb	D	Hard
3.26	e0ef59fa-d068-4fe0-a711-c0cfe98b9185	A	Hard
3.27	c6925857-6ee5-4d22-bcad-1f31a98fa419	A	Hard
3.28	758fbc90-f07d-463d-9e8a-30c83122b3ce	B	Hard
3.29	6a78cf5a-062e-4db2-9381-1775d8d08c15	A	Hard
3.30	d4aae75d-6547-4de4-ae69-d3419e693a32	A	Hard
3.31	21fbde8c-e745-471a-9fa8-b2cee04b8ed2	B	Hard
3.32	190c6d23-964f-492f-be93-b2dcb880a09c	D	Hard
3.33	f6f803fa-d374-4157-9aaf-f64022a12a4b	C	Hard
3.34	b80deb69-694b-483f-bf34-a0354855c351	B	Hard
3.35	79863ab0-1eb0-4a5f-ada0-744b9137e41b	D	Hard
3.36	47afaaa9-8c03-407e-a86f-61898f5eb0be	A	Hard
3.37	4630a3d6-55e9-46b9-b24d-1aaf315df76b	C	Hard
3.38	fe470995-4b5b-4316-86cc-b2a363cc3737	B	Hard
3.39	c1511bfa-bdff-47a6-946b-2041f9cdb4d7	C	Hard
3.40	37abd28a-364b-4181-b8f0-03137396a0f4	A	Hard
3.41	ddf2d37c-18bd-4bb1-bedf-9a2f4de6b4e4	B	Hard
3.42	b3394e1d-8bef-4690-96df-747d1268c0fe	D	Hard
3.43	53ecfe5c-e6d8-4999-bf16-4666aa36acaf	C	Hard
3.44	3867bb67-ce72-40ca-a140-79b0a6b50603	D	Hard
3.45	2cb7d276-a3f1-44ba-8645-a326ee968120	D	Hard
3.46	f08c7902-ce6e-41a2-9e7f-ce75f04a265b	D	Hard
3.47	a171e670-9a31-475a-924f-3700761b490b	D	Hard
3.48	f155ec07-5374-4ced-81d2-5bb890c07633	D	Hard

3.49	f7255304-c01b-4724-93c7-be429e27ea76	C	Hard
3.50	cea96fdd-ebbd-442a-8b87-1b4e0568d15c	D	Hard
3.51	a1fa2a51-c2ae-4892-8ffc-41238399100e	A	Hard
3.52	58385fcc-c386-4743-8021-f2d3c14f8b66	C	Hard
3.53	7d35af27-68b0-465a-80d0-29820bbdaa6c	A	Hard
3.54	5321cf85-25cc-4b37-9b52-4aa249dafd17	D	Hard
3.55	205f5245-08e7-4611-9731-a5ec8b73a181	A	Hard
3.56	9d7efeb8-a63e-4a31-ae50-bb9901cf58fe	B	Hard
3.57	ef8b6b4b-e008-4899-a590-6d785c9b9eff	B	Hard
3.58	3278d8b3-d2c0-42fb-a33c-0dc1c901b044	A	Hard
3.59	e904cc7f-71fb-43e2-92d1-6737d4fefaeb	B	Hard
3.60	ce93882d-e9b3-4571-9397-90d1592b6836	A	Hard
3.61	6e2125bc-2edd-4413-a45d-c26fbe9f9fd9	C	Hard
3.62	6bdebc9a-4dfe-43f2-8b13-576a2c99847f	A	Hard
3.63	7d391581-9063-440c-8056-91b148e5aceb	A	Hard
3.64	b13612d3-41b3-4be6-9c7c-3b2f739b4cdb	D	Hard
3.65	cf47f4f6-bab4-44f6-82fd-17fbbf30c460	B	Hard
3.66	859b0c99-ba39-402b-950e-6ea7f8512193	C	Hard
3.67	af8c6ab9-7395-46cf-8f90-531ef0739c5d	C	Hard
3.68	0f97b9c6-806b-4be8-b57f-75c74183ed6a	B	Hard
3.69	849dbfd4-a703-4e5f-9a77-444840ef8712	B	Hard
3.70	5bbed69a-9680-4d41-95a7-8291a97873e4	D	Hard
3.71	344d2279-223b-4e5e-89b6-609e08488125	B	Hard

Rationales

▼ 3.1 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the introductory subordinate clause ("With⋯windows") and the main clause ("transitional design splits the difference between old and new").

Choice A is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to separate the subordinate clause ("With⋯windows") from the main clause ("transitional⋯new"). Choice B is incorrect because a dash can't be used in this way to separate the subordinate clause ("With⋯windows") from the main clause ("transitional⋯new"). Choice C is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "with."

▼ 3.2 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation between a modifier and a noun and also between a subject and a verb. No punctuation is needed when, as in this case, a modifying phrase ("roughly 200,000 km^2k m squared") precedes the noun phrase it modifies ("Puntland Desert") to form the subject of the sentence. Additionally, no punctuation is needed between the subject ("The roughly...Desert") and the main verb ("is classified").

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the main verb. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the modifier and the noun phrase. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the modifier and the noun phrase, nor is it needed between the subject and the main verb.

▼ 3.3 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of elements in a complex series. It's conventional to use a semicolon to separate items in a complex series with internal punctuation, and in this choice, the semicolon after "leaves" is conventionally used to separate the first item ("natural debris, such as dried leaves") and the second item ("man-made trash, such as plastic bags") in the series of materials used by Gavua. Further, the comma after "trash" correctly separates the noun phrase "man-made trash" from the supplementary phrase ("such as plastic bags") that describes it.

Choice A is incorrect because a comma after "leaves" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second and third items in the series ("man-made...bags" and "and...glue"). Additionally, it's not conventional to use a colon in this way to separate a supplementary phrase ("such as plastic bags") from the noun phrase it modifies ("man-

made trash"). Choice C is incorrect because a comma after "leaves" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second and third items in the series ("man-made...bags" and "and...glue"). Choice D is incorrect because it's not conventional to use a semicolon in this way to separate a supplementary phrase ("such as plastic bags") from the noun phrase it modifies ("man-made trash").

▼ 3.4 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation in a sentence. In this choice, a colon is correctly used to mark the boundary between one main clause ("Along with...photosynthesis") and another main clause ("as light...oxygen") and to introduce the following explanation of how light intensity affects photosynthesis.

Choice A is incorrect because when coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction ("and"). Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a coordinating conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses ("Along with...photosynthesis" and "as light...oxygen"). Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses ("Along with...photosynthesis" and "as light...oxygen") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 3.5 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of an integrated relative clause. No punctuation is needed before the relative clause beginning with "that" because the content of the relative clause ("that...Lighthouse") is integral to the meaning of the coordinated adjectival phrase ("so bright, so localized, and so dependable") that it modifies.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the coordinated adjectival phrase ("so bright...dependable") and the integrated relative clause that modifies it. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the coordinated adjectival phrase ("so bright...dependable") and the integrated relative clause that modifies it. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the coordinated adjectival phrase ("so bright...dependable") and the integrated relative clause that modifies it.

▼ 3.6 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb

"though" from the preceding main clause ("Jetties can sometimes have the opposite effect") and uses a semicolon to join the next main clause ("obstructing⋯areas") to the rest of the sentence. Further, placing the semicolon after "though" logically indicates that the information earlier in this sentence (that jetties can sometimes cause erosion) is contrary to what might be assumed from the information in the previous sentence (that jetties are often constructed for the purpose of protecting coastlines from erosion).

Choice B is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the two main clauses with appropriate punctuation. With "though⋯areas" functioning as a subordinate clause following the comma, this choice illogically indicates that the following information (that obstructing the natural flow of sand along the shore can sometimes lead to erosion) is contrary to the information earlier in the sentence (that jetties can sometimes cause erosion). Instead, the information following "though" supports the previous claim about the erosive effects of jetties. Choice C is incorrect because it's not conventional to use a semicolon in this way to separate a main clause from a dependent clause. Further, it illogically indicates that the following information (that obstructing the natural flow of sand along the shore can sometimes lead to erosion) is contrary to the information earlier in the sentence (that jetties can sometimes cause erosion). Instead, the information following "though" supports the previous claim about the erosive effects of jetties. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Commas can't be used in this way to set off a supplementary word or phrase between two main clauses.

▼ 3.7 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation around noun phrases. No punctuation is needed because the noun phrase "aluminum oxide" is a restrictive appositive, meaning that it provides essential identifying information about the noun phrase before it, "the chemical compound," and thus doesn't require punctuation around it.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Choice C is incorrect because the noun phrase "aluminum oxide" is a restrictive appositive. Setting the phrase off with punctuation suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn't the case.

▼ 3.8 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between the

first sentence (“On⋯temperature”) and the second sentence (“Adding⋯effect”). The gerund phrase beginning with “adding” is the subject of the second sentence, and the verb phrase “helps combat this effect” describes what adding a light-colored covering can do.

Choice A is incorrect because a semicolon can’t be used in this way to join the sentence “On…temperature” and the supplementary phrases that follow. Doing so leaves the verb phrase “helps combat” without a subject and thus results in a grammatically unconventional sentence. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice D is incorrect. This choice results in a confusing and illogical sentence that suggests that adding a light-colored covering to an existing dark roof raises the temperature of the surrounding air. Furthermore, it creates ambiguity by leaving the verb phrase “helps combat” without a subject (so it isn’t clear what helps combat the effect).

▼ 3.9 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of items in a complex series. It’s conventional to use a semicolon to separate items in a complex series with internal punctuation, and in this choice, the semicolon after “2009” is conventionally used to separate the first item (“the world’s⋯2009”) and the second item (“an online⋯ 2010”) in the series of things that Hinson helped create. Further, the comma after “Basic” correctly pairs with the comma after “app,” and the comma after “network” correctly pairs with the comma after “TV” to set off the supplemental elements (“Chickasaw Basic” and “Chickasaw TV”) that provide the names of the app and the TV network, respectively. Altogether, the punctuation in this choice results in a sentence that clearly indicates that Hinson helped make a language app in 2009, an online TV network in 2010, and a language course in 2015.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to punctuate the complex series in a way that makes clear that Hinson helped make a language app in 2009, an online TV network in 2010, and a language course in 2015. Choice B is incorrect because it fails to punctuate the complex series in a way that makes clear that Hinson helped make a language app in 2009, an online TV network in 2010, and a language course in 2015. Choice D is incorrect because the comma after “2009” doesn’t match the semicolon used to separate the second and third items in the complex series.

▼ 3.10 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation between titles and proper nouns. No punctuation is needed to set off the coordinated noun phrase "Chile and Luxembourg" from the title that describes the two countries, "fellow OECD nations." Because the proper nouns "Chile and Luxembourg" are essential information identifying the "fellow OECD nations," no punctuation is necessary.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the country names ("Chile and Luxembourg") and the title ("fellow OECD nations") describing them. Further, setting the countries' names off with commas suggests that they could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn't the case. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the country names ("Chile and Luxembourg") and the title ("fellow OECD nations") describing them. Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the country names ("Chile and Luxembourg") and the title ("fellow OECD nations") describing them. Placing a colon after "nations" would confusingly suggest that these were the costs of the basket of goods for "fellow OECD nations" in general, not for Chile and Luxembourg specifically.

▼ 3.11 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation between titles and proper nouns. No punctuation is needed to set off the proper noun "Diane Massam" from the title that describes Massam, "linguist." Because "Diane Massam" is essential information identifying the "linguist," no punctuation is necessary.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed before or after the proper noun "Diane Massam." Setting the linguist's name off with commas suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn't the case. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed.

▼ 3.12 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. Placing the semicolon after the supplementary adverb "though" correctly indicates that the contrast in the text is between the information in the first sentence (that Earth's magnetic poles have remained fixed for the past 20 million years) and the initial clause of the second sentence ("This has not always been the case"), rather than between the two clauses of the second sentence.

Choice A is incorrect. Using the adverb “though” as the head of a subordinate clause illogically indicates that the information in the previous main clause (“This⋯case”) is contrary to the information in the subordinate clause. Instead, the information in the second clause (that Earth’s magnetic poles have swapped places several times) elaborates on the statement made in the previous clause (that Earth’s magnetic poles are not as fixed as they may seem). Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Commas can’t be used in this way to punctuate a supplementary word or phrase between two main clauses. Choice C is incorrect. Using a semicolon after “case” places the adverb “though” inside the second main clause (“throughout⋯wandering”), illogically indicating that the information in the previous main clause is contrary to the information in the second one. Instead, the information in the second main clause (that Earth’s magnetic poles have swapped places several times) elaborates on the statement made in the previous clause (that Earth’s magnetic poles are not as fixed as they may seem).

▼ 3.13 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a dash after the main clause (“Later…name”) to introduce the supplementary element (“Gangnam…Korea”) that identifies the place that inspired the song’s name.

Choice A is incorrect because a semicolon can’t be used in this way to join the main clause (“Later…name”) and the supplementary element (“Gangnam…Korea”). A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with “Gangnam.” Choice C is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the main clause and the supplementary element with appropriate punctuation.

▼ 3.14 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The text uses a dash to introduce a nonessential element that explains the acronym FESTAC. The dash matches the dash that comes after “known,” ending the descriptive aside.

Choice A is incorrect. A colon can only come after an independent clause, which isn’t the case here. Choice C is incorrect. While punctuation is required to set off “or FESTAC⋯ known” from the rest of the sentence, nonessential elements must be separated from the sentence with matching punctuation. Since a dash appears on the other side of the element, we can’t use a comma here. Choice D is incorrect. The descriptive aside “or FESTAC⋯

known” is a nonessential element that must be separated with punctuation from the rest of the sentence. This choice fails to add the necessary punctuation before the nonessential element.

▼ 3.15 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice uses a semicolon in a conventional way to join the first main clause (“That…Chulalongkorn”) and the second main clause (“deterring…achievement”).

Choice B is incorrect. Using the conjunction “that” to introduce “deterring…achievement” as a subordinate element of the main clause (“That…Chulalongkorn”) results in a confusing and ungrammatical sentence. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can’t be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 3.16 — B

Choice B is the best answer. “Marie tharp” is essential information that completes the first clause — the first clause doesn’t function without it. So we don’t want to separate it with punctuation.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error. “The field of geological oceanography owes much to American geologist” is unclear: which geologist are we talking about? We need the “Marie Tharp” for clarity, which means it’s essential information and should not be separated by a comma. Choice C is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error. “The field of geological oceanography owes much to American geologist” is unclear: which geologist are we talking about? We need the “Marie Tharp” for clarity, which means it’s essential information and should not be separated by a semicolon. Choice D is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error. “The field of geological oceanography owes much to American geologist” is unclear: which geologist are we talking about? We need the “Marie Tharp” for clarity, which means it’s essential information and should not be separated by a colon.

▼ 3.17 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used to correctly mark the boundary between one sentence ("A ray…works") and another ("Because…image").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two sentences ("A ray⋯ works" and "Because⋯image") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Since the contraction "it's" creates a main clause, the comma after "single ray" can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between two main clauses ("it's...ray" and "all light⋯image").

▼ 3.18 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The dashes after "models" and "decision-makers" correctly separate the supplementary element "which assume that people are consistently rational decision-makers" from the rest of the sentence. This punctuation indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice B is incorrect because a comma can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because it interrupts the sentence at an illogical and grammatically incoherent point. The dash should be placed before "which," not after it, to mark the beginning of the supplementary element.

▼ 3.19 — A

Choice A is the best answer. This choice uses a semicolon to join two independent clauses ("Nakalembe doesn't just⋯though" and "she also shares..."). This choice also appropriately includes "though" in the first clause, where it logically belongs.

Choice B is incorrect. This choice results in a grammar error called a comma splice. It incorrectly joins two independent clauses with only a comma instead of a comma and a coordinating conjunction like "and" or "but." "Though" is a transition word, but it's not a coordinating conjunction. Choice C is incorrect. This choice results in a punctuation error. A semicolon can only be used to link two independent clauses. However, if "though" is included in the second clause, it turns the second clause into a dependent clause, so a semicolon can't be used after "information." Choice D is incorrect. This choice results in a grammar error called a comma splice. It incorrectly joins two independent clauses with only a comma instead of a comma and a coordinating conjunction like "and" or "but."

▼ 3.20 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period after “Bay” is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence (“On⋯Bay”) and another sentence that begins with a supplementary phrase (“Having⋯years”). Here, the supplementary phrase beginning with “having” modifies the subject of the second sentence, “the celebrated ship.”

Choice A is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction “and” can’t be used in this way to join sentences. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to join two sentences. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences (“On⋯Bay” and “having⋯years”) are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 3.21 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between sentences. In this choice, the period is used to correctly mark the boundary between one sentence ("Jamaican⋯microsculptures") and another ("Creations⋯strands"). The noun phrase beginning with "creations" modifies the subject of the next sentence, "Wigan’s sculptures."

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("Jamaican⋯ microsculptures" and "Creations⋯strands") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice D is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can’t be used in this way to join sentences.

▼ 3.22 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between the first sentence (“Alberto…*Belgravia*”) and the second (“Published…available”). The participial phrase beginning with “published” contains a complex series punctuated with commas and semicolons (“the Australian cities of Melbourne, Adelaide, and Hobart; the continental European cities of Brussels, Paris, and Turin; and cities in Turkey, India, and Jamaica”), and this participial phrase modifies the subject of the second sentence, “this magazine.”

Choice A is incorrect. Using a semicolon to join two main clauses in this way in combination with the semicolons that separate the items in the complex series would result in an

ambiguous and confusing sentence. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. With no punctuation after "*Belgravia*," the participial phrase "published…Jamaica" reads as an integrated modifier within the noun phrase "the magazine *Belgravia*," and the first main clause ("Alberto…Jamaica") is then joined to a second main clause ("this…available") using only a comma. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses.

▼ 3.23 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a name and title and between a subject and a verb. No punctuation is needed between the proper noun "Heather Grab" and "entomologist," the title that describes Grab. Additionally, no punctuation is needed between the sentence's subject ("Entomologist Heather Grab") and the main verb ("found") that indicates what Grab did.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Setting the entomologist's name off with commas suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn't the case. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

▼ 3.24 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The clause "A subseasonal⋯advance" and the clause "its predictions⋯forecast" are both independent clauses, so using a semicolon to separate them is grammatically correct.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice creates a run-on sentence error. The clause "A subseasonal⋯advance" and the clause "its predictions⋯forecast" are both independent clauses, so a comma is not enough to separate them. Choice B is incorrect. This choice creates a run-on sentence error. The clause "A subseasonal⋯advance" and the clause "its predictions⋯forecast" are both independent clauses, so they need to be separated with specific punctuation (a period, a semi-colon, a colon, a dash, or a comma + a coordinating conjunction). Choice D is incorrect. This choice creates a run-on sentence error. The clause "A subseasonal⋯advance" and the clause "its predictions⋯forecast" are both independent clauses, so the word "and" by itself is not enough to separate them. There would need to be a comma before "and" for this choice to work.

▼ 3.25 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The conventions being tested are punctuation use between sentences and the punctuation of a supplementary element. This choice correctly uses a period to mark the boundary between one sentence ("During...one") and another ("The *Katzenbach*...event") and uses a comma to separate the supplementary phrase "for one" from the preceding main clause. Further, placing the period after "for one" correctly indicates that the information in the preceding main clause ("the founding...1929") is the first example provided of a pivotal event in the Latino rights movement.

Choice A is incorrect because placing the period after "1929" illogically indicates that the information in the next main clause (describing the *Katzenbach v. Morgan* court decision) is the first example provided of a pivotal event in the Latino rights movement; rather, it's a second example. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Moreover, it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element "for one" from the preceding main clause.

▼ 3.26 — A

Choice A is the best answer. This choice uses a comma and a coordinating conjunction ("and") to join two independent clauses ("The Tantaquidgeon⋯Tribe" and "Today⋯country").

Choice B is incorrect. This choice results in a grammar error known as a run-on sentence. The clauses before and after "Tribe" are both independent, so they need to be separated with some sort of punctuation. Choice C is incorrect. This choice results in a grammar error known as a run-on sentence. The clauses before and after "and" are both independent, so they can't be linked with just a conjunction. A comma would also be required. Choice D is incorrect. This choice results in a grammar error called a comma splice. The clauses before and after "Tribe" are both independent, so they can't be linked with just a comma. A coordinating conjunction like "and" or "but" would also be required.

▼ 3.27 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("However...earlier") and another ("In...area"). The supplementary phrase "in 1420 CE" modifies "humans," the subject of the third sentence.

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Moreover, the subordinating conjunction “which” creates a confusing and illogical sentence that suggests that the supplementary phrase beginning with “in” modifies the previous information (“However…earlier”) rather than the information that follows. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences (“However…earlier” and “in…area”) are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 3.28 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between main clauses and a supplementary element. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the main clause ("The vessel took six days to dislodge") and the supplementary element ("in part due to its sheer size") that provides additional information on why the vessel was difficult to dislodge. Additionally, this choice correctly uses a colon to introduce another main clause that describes the vessel’s size ("it’s as heavy as two thousand blue whales when fully loaded").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between two main clauses ("The vessel⋯size" and "it’s⋯ loaded"). Additionally, it fails to mark the boundary between the main clause ("The vessel took six days to dislodge") and the supplementary element ("in part due to its sheer size"). Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between two main clauses ("The vessel⋯size" and "it’s⋯ loaded"). Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses ("The vessel⋯size" and "it’s⋯loaded") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 3.29 — A

Choice A is the best answer. “That is⋯field” is an essential supplement, so we should not use punctuation to separate it from “scuba diving club.” .

Choice B is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error. “That is⋯field” is an essential supplement, so we should not use a comma (or any kind of punctuation) to separate it from “scuba diving club.” . Choice C is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error. “That is⋯field” is an essential supplement, so we should not use a dash (or any kind of punctuation) to separate it from “scuba diving club.” . Choice D is incorrect. This choice

creates a run-on sentence. It makes “that is⋯United States” into an awkward independent clause, but it also makes “that has⋯field” into its own awkward independent clause without the correct punctuation separating it.

▼ 3.30 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("In⋯plant") and another ("By⋯weeds"). The prepositional phrase beginning with "by" modifies the subject of the next sentence, "she," which refers to Macías-Rubalcava.

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to join two sentences. Choice C is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can’t be used in this way to join two sentences. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two sentences are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 3.31 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of an integrated relative clause within a sentence. No punctuation is needed between the noun phrase (“The natural and mechanical materials”) and the integrated relative clause (“that Palma Rodríguez uses in his art”). The integrated relative clause provides essential information about the materials, so no punctuation should separate it from the noun phrase it modifies. Additionally, no punctuation is needed between the sentence’s subject (“The natural and mechanical materials that Palma Rodríguez uses in his art”) and its main verb (“highlight”).

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the sentence’s subject (“The natural…art”) and its main verb (“highlight”). Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the noun phrase (“The natural…materials”) and the integrated relative clause (“that…art”) that modifies it. Additionally, no punctuation is needed between the sentence’s subject (“The natural…art”) and its main verb (“highlight”). Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the noun phrase (“The natural…materials”) and the integrated relative clause (“that…art”) that modifies it.

▼ 3.32 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between two main clauses. In this choice, a colon is correctly used to mark the boundary between one main clause ("goats are notoriously indiscriminate") and another main clause ("they will

devour all kinds of shrubs and weeds") and to introduce the following explanation of goats' nondiscriminatory behavior when it comes to what they eat.

Choice A is incorrect because when coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction. Furthermore, the conjunction "and" fails to indicate that what follows is an explanation of goats' nondiscriminatory behavior when it comes to their diets. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses ("goats⋯indiscriminate" and "they⋯weeds"). Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses ("goats⋯indiscriminate" and "they⋯weeds") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 3.33 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use within a sentence. A colon can be used between two main clauses to signal that what follows is an elaboration of what came before. In this choice, the colon correctly introduces the following explanation of the divergent milk preservation strategies that emerged.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The main clause ("As⋯ emerged") and the subordinate clause followed by another main clause ("whereas⋯steppe") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can't be used in this way to join a main clause ("As⋯ emerged") and a subordinate clause followed by another main clause ("whereas⋯steppe"). Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join a main clause ("As⋯emerged") and a subordinate clause followed by another main clause ("whereas⋯steppe").

▼ 3.34 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a main clause and a supplementary phrase. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the main clause ("the portraits...quilts") and the supplementary noun phrase ("the stitching...fabric") that provides a further description of how the portraits can be identified as quilts.

Choice A is incorrect. A comma and the conjunction "and" can't be used in this way to join a main clause and a supplementary noun phrase. Choice C is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join a main clause and a supplementary noun phrase. Choice D

is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with “the stitching.”

▼ 3.35 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary element within a sentence. The dash after “Ecuador” and the closing parenthesis pairs with the dash after “territories” to separate the supplementary element (“New…Ecuador”) from the rest of the sentence. The supplementary element specifies the three South American territories that Simón Bolívar liberated, and the pair of dashes indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Furthermore, punctuation isn’t needed between “Ecuador” and the closing parenthesis. Choice B is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because a comma can’t be paired with a dash to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 3.36 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation to mark boundaries between supplements and clauses. The comma after “equations” is used to separate the independent clause (“Hopper’s…equation”) from the supplementary adverb phrase “though.” The colon after “though” is used to mark the boundary between the clause ending with “though” and the following clause (“as…age”). A colon used in this way introduces information that illustrates or explains information that has come before it. In this case, the colon after “though” introduces the following explanation of how Hopper’s subsequent career would involve more than just solving equations: she would become a pioneering computer programmer.

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to join two independent clauses (“Hopper’s…though” and “as…age”) such as these. Choice C is incorrect because it results in an illogical sequence of sentences. Placing the period after “equations” and beginning the next sentence with “Though” illogically suggests that the following information (that Hopper would help usher in the digital age) is contrary to the information in the previous sentence (Hopper’s subsequent career would involve more than just solving equations). Instead, the information that follows supports the information

from the previous sentence by explaining how her work and influence extended beyond solely solving equations. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two independent clauses (“Hopper’s⋯though” and “as⋯age”) are fused without punctuation.

▼ 3.37 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb "though" from the preceding main clause ("Economists⋯conservation") and uses a semicolon to join the next main clause ("efficiency gains⋯rises") to the rest of the sentence. Further, placing the semicolon after "though" indicates that the information in the preceding main clause ("improvements in efficiency often correlate negatively with resource conservation") is contrary to what might be assumed from the information in the previous sentence (resource consumption would be expected to decrease with the development of new, more efficient technologies).

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Commas can’t be used in this way to punctuate a supplementary word or phrase between two main clauses. Choice B is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the two main clauses ("Economists...though" and "efficiency gains....rises") with appropriate punctuation. Moreover, placing the semicolon after "conservation" illogically indicates that the information in the next clause (gains in efficiency may lead to an increase in resource consumption) is contrary to the information in the previous clause ("improvements in efficiency often correlate negatively with resource conservation"). Choice D is incorrect because placing a comma after "conservation" illogically indicates that the information in the next clause (gains in efficiency may lead to an increase in resource consumption) is contrary to the information in the previous clause ("improvements in efficiency often correlate negatively with resource conservation").

▼ 3.38 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of items in a complex series (a series including internal punctuation). In this choice, the semicolon after “Lagos” is conventionally used to separate the first item (“*The Joys*⋯Lagos”) and the second item (“*A Kind*⋯Nigeria”) in the series. Further, the comma after “*Marriage*” correctly separates the title “*A Kind of Marriage*” from the supplementary phrase (“a television⋯ Nigeria”) that describes it.

Choice A is incorrect because the comma after “Lagos” doesn’t match the semicolon used later in the series to separate the second item (“*A Kind*⋯Nigeria”) from the third item (“and⋯autobiography”). Choice C is incorrect because the comma after “Lagos” doesn’t match the semicolon used later in the series to separate the second item (“*A Kind*⋯Nigeria”) from the third item (“and⋯autobiography”). Additionally, a colon can’t be used in this way to separate the title “*A Kind of Marriage*” from the supplementary phrase (“a television⋯ Nigeria”) that describes it. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the title “*A Kind of Marriage*” from the supplementary phrase (“a television⋯Nigeria”) that describes it.

▼ 3.39 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a semicolon to join a main clause (“Saville…novel”) and a second main clause (“she’s…it”) preceded by supplementary elements (“rather…narrative”).

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can’t be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, the comma after “novel” can’t be used in this way to join the two main clauses.

▼ 3.40 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. This choice correctly uses a period to mark the boundary between one sentence ("The pedagogy…tenets") and another ("Developed…‘March in G’"). The participial phrase "developed by Japanese violinist Shinichi Suzuki" modifies the subject of the next sentence, "the method."

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("The pedagogy…tenets" and "Developed…‘March in G’") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it creates a confusing and illogical sentence structure. The relative pronoun "that" followed by a comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences.

▼ 3.41 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of elements in a complex series. It's conventional to use a semicolon to separate items in a complex series with internal punctuation, and in this choice, the semicolon after "time" is conventionally used to separate the first item ("offered…time") and the second ("celebrated…holiday") in the series of activities that librarian Pura Belpré offered. Moreover, the semicolon after "time" matches the semicolon used later to separate the second item ("celebrated...holiday") and the third ("and...folktales") in the series.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the first item and the second item in the complex series. Furthermore, a comma isn't needed between the noun "practice" and the prepositional phrase "at the time" because the prepositional phrase is essential to the full meaning of the phrase "an uncommon practice at the time." Choice C is incorrect because a comma after "time" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second ("celebrated...holiday") and third ("and...folktales") items in the series. Furthermore, a comma isn't needed between the noun "practice" and the prepositional phrase "at the time" because the prepositional phrase is essential to the full meaning of the phrase "an uncommon practice at the time." Choice D is incorrect because a comma after "time" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second ("celebrated...holiday") and third ("and...folktales") items in the series.

▼ 3.42 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The independent clauses "researcher Lin Zhi…silk" and "by dissolving…2 GPa" can be grammatically separated by a period. They can stand alone as sentences, and this is the only choice that lets them do that.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice results in a grammar error called a comma splice. "Researcher Lin Zhi…silk" and "by dissolving…2 GPa" are both independent clauses. They need to either be separated with punctuation like a period or a semicolon, or they need to be connected by a comma and a coordinating conjunction like "and." A comma alone isn't enough. Choice B is incorrect. This choice results in a grammar error called a run-on sentence. "Researcher Lin Zhi…silk" and "by dissolving…2 GPa" are both independent clauses. They need to either be separated with punctuation like a period or a semicolon, or they need to be connected by a comma and a coordinating conjunction like "and." Choice C is incorrect. This choice results in a grammar error called a run-on sentence. "Researcher

Lin Zhi…silk" and "by dissolving…2 GPa" are both independent clauses. The coordinating conjunction "and" isn't enough to link them by itself. We need a comma, too.

▼ 3.43 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The dash after "vibrato" pairs with the dash after "abilities" to separate the supplementary element ("acquiring...vibrato") from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to describe the vocal abilities Vaughan developed, and the pair of dashes indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because a colon can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice B is incorrect because a comma can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 3.44 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a main clause and a supplementary phrase. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the main clause ("The haiku-like…writers") and the supplementary phrase ("among…Cole") that specifies a contemporary writer who has praised Tomas Tranströmer's haiku-like poems.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "among." Choice B is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the main clause and the supplementary phrase with appropriate punctuation. Choice C is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join the main clause ("The haiku-like…writers") and the supplementary phrase ("among…Cole").

▼ 3.45 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb "however" from the preceding main clause ("Compiling...languages") and uses a semicolon to join the next main clause ("any...tool") to the rest of the sentence. Further, placing the semicolon after "however" indicates that the information in the preceding main clause ("compiling isn't exclusive to certain programming languages") is contrary to what might be

assumed from the information in the previous sentence (Scala's status as a compiled programming language might suggest that compiling is unique to certain languages).

Choice A is incorrect because placing a period after "languages" and starting a new sentence with "however" illogically indicates that the information in the next sentence (any language can incorporate a compiler) is contrary to the information in the previous sentence ("compiling isn't exclusive to certain programming languages"). Instead, the information following "however" supports the previous claim. Choice B is incorrect because placing the semicolon after "languages" illogically indicates that the information in the next main clause (any language can incorporate a compiler) is contrary to the information in the previous clause ("compiling isn't exclusive to certain programming languages"). Instead, the information following "however" supports the previous claim. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Commas can't be used in this way to punctuate a supplementary word or phrase between two main clauses.

▼ 3.46 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period after "essays" is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("American⋯essays") and another ("praising⋯Morrison"). The participial phrase beginning with "Praising" modifies the subject of the second sentence, "writer Robert Antoni."

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice B is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can't be used in this way to join sentences. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("American⋯essays" and "Praising⋯Morrison") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 3.47 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("The poem⋯exclamation") and another sentence that begins with a supplementary element ("Translated⋯poem"). The supplementary element "translated as 'hark!' or 'listen!' in some versions" modifies the subject of the second sentence, "the word" (referring to hwæt).

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice after "exclamation." A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice B is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can’t be used in this way to join sentences. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice after "versions." A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences.

▼ 3.48 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of a colon within a sentence. In this choice, the colon correctly introduces the following explanation of the different functions of genomes and epigenomes.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses ("The relationship…functions" and "whereas…expressed") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to join two main clauses ("The relationship…functions" and "whereas… expressed"). Choice C is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can’t be used in this way to join two main clauses. Furthermore, "and" fails to indicate that what follows is an explanation of how cells with identical DNA develop different functions.

▼ 3.49 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary phrase following a clause. This choice uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb phrase "however" from the independent clause it modifies ("They...antiquity") and uses a semicolon to join the first independent clause ("They...antiquity") and the second independent clause ("some...literature"). Further, placing the semicolon after "however" indicates that the information in the clause that this is part of (that neoclassical writers were not the first to adopt classical literary modes) is contrary to what might be assumed from the information in the previous sentence (that the neoclassical writers were unique in imitating classical epic poetry and satires).

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary after "however" between the two independent clauses with appropriate punctuation. Choice B is incorrect because the comma after "however" can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between the two independent clauses. Choice D is incorrect because placing the semicolon after "antiquity" illogically indicates that the information in the clause that this is part of (that prominent Renaissance figures were also influenced by classical literature) is contrary to the

information in the previous clause (that neoclassical writers were not the first to adopt classical literary modes).

▼ 3.50 — D

Choice D is the best answer. This choice correctly uses a semicolon to punctuate a complex list (which is made up of items that have commas in them).

Choice A is incorrect. This is a complex list, indicated by the semicolon between "1998" and "Carolyn Bertozzi." What comes after the blank is a separate list item, so punctuation is needed after "Stanford." Choice B is incorrect. This is a complex list, indicated by the semicolon between "1998" and "Carolyn Bertozzi." The items in this list have internal punctuation in the form of commas and must therefore be separated by semicolons to avoid confusion. Choice C is incorrect. This is a complex list, indicated by the semicolon between "1998" and "Carolyn Bertozzi." Colons aren't used to separate items in a list.

▼ 3.51 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary word or phrase between two main clauses. This choice correctly uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb "however" from the preceding main clause ("Okinaka doesn't⋯single-handedly") and a semicolon to join the next main clause ("all⋯ culture") to the rest of the sentence. Further, placing the semicolon after "however" correctly indicates that the information in the preceding main clause (Okinaka doesn't make such decisions single-handedly) is contrary to what might be assumed from the information in the previous sentence (Okinaka sits on the review board that adds new sites to the Hawaii Register of Historic Places).

Choice B is incorrect because placing the semicolon after "single-handedly" and the comma after "however" illogically indicates that the information in the next main clause (all historical designations must be approved by a group of experts) is contrary to the information in the previous clause (Okinaka doesn't make such decisions single-handedly). Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Commas can't be used in this way to punctuate a supplementary word or phrase between two main clauses. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 3.52 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of elements in a complex series. It's conventional to use a semicolon to separate items in a complex series with internal punctuation, and in this choice, the semicolon after "items" is conventionally used to separate the first item ("overseeing…items") and the second item ("managing… law") in a list of Hayden's responsibilities.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the first item and the second item in the complex series. Choice B is incorrect because a comma after "items" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second and third items in the series ("managing…law" and "and appointing the US poet laureate"). Choice D is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "Managing."

▼ 3.53 — A

Choice A is the best answer. "A team…tried something new" is an independent clause leading to an explanation of what the new thing was. A colon can only be used at the end of an independent clause, and typically introduces further explanation that expands upon the first clause, which makes a colon the perfect choice here.

Choice B is incorrect. This choice results in a punctuation error. "Sequencing…dental plaque" can't stand on its own as a sentence, and so it can't be linked to the independent clause "a team…tried something new" with a semicolon. Only two independent clauses can be connected in this way. Choice C is incorrect. This choice results in a punctuation error. If "sequencing" is included in the first clause, it can no longer stand on its own as a complete idea. Since a colon can only come at the end of an independent clause, using one in this way creates an error. Choice D is incorrect. This choice results in a sentence fragment. "Sequencing…dental plaque" can't stand on its own as a sentence.

▼ 3.54 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a main clause and a supplementary phrase. In this choice, a colon is correctly used to mark the boundary between the main clause ("A group…plant") and the supplementary element ("TN57…pests") and to introduce the following elaboration on the specific varieties of sweet potato plants that were examined.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "TN57." Choice B is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way

to join the main clause (“A group⋯plant”) and the supplementary element (“TN57⋯pests”). A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses, whereas a colon is conventionally used to introduce an element that explains or amplifies the information in the preceding clause. Choice C is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the main clause (“A group…plant”) and the supplementary element (“TN57…pests”) with appropriate punctuation.

▼ 3.55 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of supplementary elements within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb "however" from the preceding main clause ("only…competitions"), and it uses a colon to introduce the list of dances that follows ("rumba⋯jive"). Further, placing the colon after "however" rather than before indicates that the information in the preceding main clause (only…competitions) is contrary to what might be assumed from the information in the previous sentence (Latin America has many more dance forms).

Choice B is incorrect. The comma after "however" can’t be used in this way to introduce a series ("rumba…jive"). Choice C is incorrect because it isn’t conventional to use a semicolon in this way to introduce a series of items, such as the list of dances. Choice D is incorrect because placing the semicolon after "competitions" illogically indicates that the following list of five Latin American dances ("rumba…jive") is contrary to the information in the previous clause (only five Latin American dances are included in international ballroom dance competitions).

▼ 3.56 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation around noun phrases. No punctuation is needed because the coordinated noun phrase "Thomas Hart Benton and Jackson Pollock" is a restrictive appositive, meaning that it provides essential identifying information about the noun phrase before it, "the renowned twentieth-century US artists."

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the noun phrase "the renowned twentieth-century US artists" and the restrictive appositive "Thomas Hart Benton and Jackson Pollock." Additionally, no punctuation is needed between the sentence’s subject ("paintings by the renowned twentieth-century US artists Thomas Hart Benton and Jackson Pollock") and the main verb ("were featured"). Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the coordinated elements "Thomas Hart Benton" and

"Jackson Pollock." Additionally, no punctuation is needed between the sentence's subject ("paintings by the renowned twentieth-century US artists Thomas Hart Benton and Jackson Pollock") and the main verb ("were featured"). Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the noun phrase "the renowned twentieth-century US artists" and the restrictive appositive "Thomas Hart Benton and Jackson Pollock."

▼ 3.57 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of items in a complex series (a series including internal punctuation). The semicolon after "nonnative" is correctly used to separate the first item ("growing diverse plant species, both native and nonnative") and the second item ("fostering scientific research") in the series of things that botanical gardens are dedicated to. Further, the comma after "species" is correctly used to separate the noun phrase "diverse plant species" and the supplementary phrase "both native and nonnative" that modifies it.

Choice A is incorrect because a comma (specifically, the comma after "nonnative") can't be used in this way to separate items in a complex series. Choice C is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to separate the noun phrase "diverse plant species" and the supplementary phrase "both native and nonnative" that modifies it. Further, a comma can't be used in this way to separate items in a complex series. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the noun phrase "diverse plant species" and the supplementary phrase "both native and nonnative" that modifies it. Further, a comma can't be used in this way to separate items in a complex series.

▼ 3.58 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The comma after "work" pairs with the comma after "though" to separate the supplementary element "though" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element signals that what follows is an exception to Chen using software tools to create illustrations, and the pair of commas indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice B is incorrect because the comma after "work" must be paired with a comma after "though" to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because a semicolon can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because a

semicolon can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 3.59 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. In this choice, a colon is correctly used after the main clause ("The radial…Earth") to introduce the complex series that follows. Furthermore, the comma after "away" is conventionally used to separate the supplementary phrase "at 41 light-years away" from the noun phrase it describes ("the gas giant 55 Cancri d"), the first item in the series.

Choice A is incorrect because placing a colon after "away" illogically separates the supplementary phrase "at 41 light-years away" from the noun phrase it describes ("the gas giant 55 Cancri d") and attaches it to the main clause ("The radial…away"), resulting in a confusing and illogical sentence. Choice C is incorrect because a comma cannot be used in this way to mark the boundary between a main clause ("The radial…Earth") and a complex series. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the main clause ("The radial…Earth") and the complex series that follows with appropriate punctuation.

▼ 3.60 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of a colon within a sentence. In this choice, the colon is correctly used to introduce the following explanation of what the Patriot cause had grown into by 1774.

Choice B is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join the main clause ("what⋯extensive") and the supplementary element ("a network⋯Congress"). A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses, whereas a colon is conventionally used to introduce an element that explains or amplifies the information in the preceding clause, making the colon the better choice in this context. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. The addition of the pronoun and verb "it was" forms the start of a new main clause in the sentence, and a comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between two main clauses. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "a network."

▼ 3.61 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma after "protest" to mark the boundary between the main clause ("For…protest") and the supplementary appositive ("a decision…possessed")

that provides additional information about Anderson's choice of narrator. Furthermore, the comma after "that" pairs with the comma after "own" to separate the supplementary adverbial phrase "by allowing…own" from the rest of the appositive. This adverbial phrase functions to explain how Anderson's choice of a narrator amplified the agency and power the hospital workers possessed, and the pair of commas indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "a decision." Choice B is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join the main clause ("For…protest") and the supplementary appositive ("a decision…possessed"). A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses, and "a decision…possessed" isn't a main clause. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the main clause ("For…protest") and the supplementary appositive ("a decision…possessed") with appropriate punctuation.

▼ 3.62 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of a colon within a sentence. In this choice, the colon is used in a conventional way to introduce the following description of how the number of jams available varied.

Choice B is incorrect because it creates a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses ("the number⋯varied" and "some⋯six"). Choice C is incorrect because it results in an illogical and confusing sentence. Using the conjunction "while" to join the main clause ("the number⋯varied") with the following clause's description of the number of jams available suggests that the variation in the number of jams is in contrast to some shoppers having twenty-four options. Choice D is incorrect because it results in an illogical and confusing sentence. Using "while" in this way suggests that the number of jams available varied during the time in which some shoppers had twenty-four options and others had six. The sentence makes clear, however, that what follows "varied" is a description of the variation, not a separate, simultaneous occurrence.

▼ 3.63 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb "respectively" from the rest of the supplementary element introduced by the dash after "entertainment" ("the Emmy…awards"), and it uses a semicolon to join the first main clause ("In…respectively") and the second main clause ("the achievement…EGOT'").

Choice B is incorrect because placing the semicolon after “awards” illogically separates the supplementary adverb “respectively” from the supplementary element it belongs to (“the Emmy…awards”) and attaches it to the following main clause (“the achievement…EGOT’”), resulting in a confusing and ungrammatical sentence. Choice C is incorrect. The dash after “respectively” pairs with the dash after “entertainment” to close the supplementary element (“the Emmy…respectively”), so it can’t also serve to mark the boundary between the two main clauses (“In…respectively” and “the achievement…EGOT’”). The result fails to mark that boundary with appropriate punctuation. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, the comma after “respectively” can’t be used in this way to join the first main clause (“In…respectively”) and the second main clause (“the achievement…EGOT’”).

▼ 3.64 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice uses a semicolon in a conventional way to join the first main clause ("The Limón⋯weightlessness") and the second main clause ("dancers⋯jump").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect. The relative pronoun "which" can’t be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can’t be used in this way to join two main clauses.

▼ 3.65 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a main clause and a supplementary phrase. In this choice, a colon is correctly used to mark the boundary between the main clause (“A study⋯continents”) and the supplementary phrase (“geological⋯above”) and to introduce the following explanation of the origin of Earth’s continents.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the main clause (“A study⋯continents”) and the supplementary phrase (“geological⋯above”) with appropriate punctuation. Choice C is incorrect because a semicolon can’t be used in this way to join the main clause (“A study⋯continents”) and the supplementary phrase (“geological⋯above”). A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses, whereas a colon is conventionally used to introduce an element that explains or amplifies the information in the preceding

clause, making it the better choice in this context. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with “geological.”

▼ 3.66 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("The city⋯system") and another ("Analyzing⋯footage"). The participial phrase beginning with "analyzing" modifies the subject of the second sentence, "the AI algorithm."

Choice A is incorrect. Placing a dash before "analyzing" creates a confusing and ambiguous modifying element ("analyzing...areas") and a comma splice between "areas" and "the AI algorithm." (A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences.) Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("The city⋯system" and "analyzing⋯footage") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 3.67 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between a subject and a verb. No punctuation is needed when the subject of a sentence is immediately followed by a main verb. In this case, the sentence’s subject (“the innovative works of Congolese sculptor and architect Bodys Isek Kingelez”) is followed by the main verb “were featured,” and no punctuation should come between them.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

▼ 3.68 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation in a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb "though" from the preceding main clause ("Such interpretations are ultimately speculative") and uses a semicolon to join the next main clause ("the object’s...makeup") to the rest of the sentence. Further, placing the semicolon after "though" indicates that the information in the preceding main clause (interpretations of an outer solar system object’s composition based on its color are ultimately speculative) is a qualification of the information in the

previous sentence (the composition of an outer solar system object is suggested by its color).

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the two main clauses with appropriate punctuation. Choice C is incorrect because placing the semicolon after "speculative" illogically indicates that the information in the next main clause ("the object's...makeup") is a qualification of the information in the previous clause ("Such...speculative"). Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Commas can't be used in this way to punctuate a supplementary word or phrase between two main clauses.

▼ 3.69 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation between titles and proper nouns. No punctuation is needed to set off the proper noun "Marie-Denise Villers" from the title that describes Villers, "little-known French portrait artist."

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed.

▼ 3.70 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a main clause and a supplementary phrase. In this choice, a colon is correctly used to mark the boundary between the main clause ("there...on") and the supplementary phrase ("openness to experience") and to introduce the information that identifies which personality trait participants scored especially high on.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "on" and separates a necessary preposition from the clause beginning with "there." Choice B is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join the main clause ("there...on") and the supplementary phrase ("openness to experience"). A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses, whereas a colon is conventionally used to introduce an element that explains or amplifies the information in the preceding clause, making the colon the better choice in this context. Choice C is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the main clause ("there...on") and the supplementary phrase ("openness to experience").

▼ 3.71 — B

Choice B is the best answer. This choice uses paired punctuation in the form of two commas to set off the nonessential phrase "in the process."

Choice A is incorrect. The phrase "in the process" is a nonessential element and needs to be set off with paired punctuation. We need a comma after "and" to match the one after "process." Choice C is incorrect. The phrase "in the process" is a nonessential element and needs to be set off with paired punctuation, so we would need a dash after "and" to match the one following "process." Choice D is incorrect. The phrase "in the process" is a nonessential element and needs to be set off with paired punctuation. We would need a comma after "process" to match the one following "and."